

Notice of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (August 6, 2026 Issue)

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We are pleased to deliver the latest information on regional and analysis reports that JETRO conducts from its unique perspective on the political and economic trends of major countries and regions around the world. We hope you will find this information useful.

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[Special Feature] Middle East Situation in Flux: Impact on Middle Eastern Countries and Outlook <Additional Article>

In response to the destabilization of the Middle East, the business environment surrounding companies operating in the region is undergoing significant change. This special feature covers the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region, tracking the latest developments in logistics and trade, various industries, and corporate initiatives, while also investigating and analyzing government responses and economic policies according to the situation. Through these analyses, we present a wide range of information that reveals geopolitical risks and new market opportunities in the MENA region from multiple perspectives, contributing to future Middle East business endeavors by Japanese companies.

<Additional Article>

◇Automotive Trends in the Middle East (3): Impact of Strait of Hormuz Closure on Parts Exports and Raw Material Procurement

[Asia: Malaysia] Sarawak State Today (Latter Part)
Energy Growth Driving Industry

Sarawak State, which has a comparative advantage in energy supply, has already begun several new energy-related projects including renewable energy and hydrogen, involving not only local companies but also foreign-affiliated companies including Japanese firms. The strengths of this energy industry are also attracting related industries such as semiconductors and electric vehicles (EVs). When entering the state, it is essential to partner with those knowledgeable about local conditions, as there are unique characteristics differing from Peninsular Malaysia, for smooth negotiations.

<Reposted>

◇Sarawak State Today (First Part): Energy Investment Concentration Progressing

[Europe: Ukraine] Zakarpattia State, Ukraine

Zakarpattia State, located at Ukraine's western extremity, borders four countries: Poland, Slovakia, Hungary, and Romania. Since Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, this state has attracted attention as a receptacle for corporate relocations and is strengthening its character not merely as a "relatively safe relocation destination," but as a manufacturing and logistics hub connected to the EU market. This is backed by over 400 corporate relocations, along with railway logistics networks connecting to the EU and concentrations of foreign-affiliated manufacturing. Based on JETRO's field survey conducted in May 2026, this article presents the investment and industrial environment of Zakarpattia State in two parts. The first part focuses on the state's geographical characteristics, advantages as a relocation destination, logistics infrastructure, and concentration of foreign-affiliated manufacturing. The latter part will examine the state from a broader regional perspective, including industrial and logistics relationships with Lviv, a core city in western Ukraine, and Košice in eastern Slovakia, and discuss business development possibilities for Japanese companies.

(1) First Part: From Relocation Destination to Manufacturing and Logistics Hub

(2) Latter Part: Cross-Border Industrial Zone Connecting with Slovakia

[Asia: India] Mundra: India's Largest Port and Industrial Zone Merging
An Industrial City Developed by Adani

Located approximately 300 kilometers west of Ahmedabad, the central city of Gujarat (GJ) State, in the Kutch region, Mundra Port is India's largest port in both cargo and container handling volumes. Geographically, Mundra Port is near India's western edge, facing the Middle East and Africa across the Arabian Sea, and further connecting to Europe via the Suez Canal. However, Mundra Port's strengths extend beyond such geographical advantages. Its defining characteristic is that it houses India's largest Special Economic Zone (SEZ) adjacent to the port and industrial areas serving the domestic market, combining logistics functions with production capabilities. Possessing vast land with a coastline exceeding 40 kilometers east to west, it has considerable room for future expansion. Its greatest characteristic is its development as an industrial city integrating industrial zones, energy facilities, and residential functions with the port as its core.

[Japan] Global Food Ingredient "TOFU" × Japanese Food Ingredient "Tofu": Possibilities

Tofu, a traditional Japanese food, is experiencing expanding demand overseas against the backdrop of growing global health consciousness. Rich in plant-based protein, it attracts interest from a wide range of consumers, including vegetarians and vegans, and exports from Japan are on an upward trend. As the global "TOFU" market expands, Japanese tofu has the potential to differentiate itself through quality and food culture as value. This article examines future export possibilities for Japanese tofu, covering the marketability of long-shelf-life paperboard-packaged tofu and future prospects for the tofu industry as a whole.